the initial hostility that the Tetley managers felt towards the acquirer company' had become a challenge, says Homi Khusrokhan, former managing director of Tata Tea.

The 'Tetley top management have strongly resisted Tata Tea's moves on issues such as the closure of the JV, the use of South Indian teas in their blend, the placement of managers in Tetley, the disposal of the US business in a timely fashion, the launch of the Tetley brand in Russia and the Middle East and the desire to integrate the two companies,' wrote Sankaranarayanan to Ratan.

Krishna Kumar, in his inimitable style, however, maintained that with a little bit of effort, the issue could be resolved. He said that the Tetley management would need some 'marriage counselling'. The implication was clear: the erstwhile management would have to accept the authority and business ethos of the majority partner, Tata Tea. And he quickly moved to institutionalize this. In a board meeting in October 2001, a proposal for the structural and operational integration of Tata Tea and Tetley was formally adopted. The Boston Consulting Group (BCG) was appointed as an external consultant for the integration process.

Ratan was unambiguous in his objective. He had undertaken the acquisition to bring benefit to Tata Tea across the value chain. It did not matter what the team at Tetley had anticipated; he had not undertaken the costly acquisition to let Tetley remain a separate organization.

There were several goals that were to be achieved through the acquisition. Tata Tea was now well-positioned to also move out of the domestic market and leverage Tetley's brand value. As Krishna Kumar outlined to the *Financial Times*, 'Being such an adored brand, [Tetley] will be used as a driver by Tata Tea to push the export of packet tea from India. There are quite a few markets where Tetley is a familiar brand but the Tetley products are not available. We are planning to make a breakthrough in such markets.'

In the meantime, Ratan and Krishna Kumar were also able to bring about incremental changes in the mindset of the Tetley workforce. The synergy that the two companies could spawn if they worked towards a unified goal in a coherent manner would by no means be insignificant. New strategies were outlined. Tetley's sales in the UK and the US were steady. Further momentum was to be harnessed through product innovation (in tea and